



THE HISTORY PORTAL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

FROM DEMOCRACY TO DICTATORSHIP: HOW DID HITLER DESTROY THE WEIMAR REPUBLIC?

*Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918-39 - Key
Topic 3: Nazi Control and Dictatorship*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: Key Topic 3.1: The Creation of a Dictatorship, 1933–1934 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q1 INFERENCE)			
L2: Key Topic 3.2: The Police State and Religion, 1933–1939 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q2 CAUSATION)			
L3: Key Topic 3.3: Controlling and Influencing Attitudes, 1933–1939 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2024 (Q3A UTILITY)			
L4: Key Topic 3.4: Opposition, Resistance and Conformity, 1933–1939 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2024 (Q3B-D INTERPRETATIONS)			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: Key Topic 3.1: The Creation of a Dictatorship, 1933–1934

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise chronological knowledge of the rapid steps Hitler took to secure power between January 1933 and August 1934.
- ☐ Analyse how Hitler used the Reichstag Fire and the Enabling Act to legally destroy political opposition and civil liberties.
- ☐ Evaluate the significance of the Night of the Long Knives and the Army Oath in eliminating internal threats and securing absolute power as Führer.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the original name of the Nazi Party?

What was the 25-Point Programme (1920)?

Who were the SA (Sturmabteilung)?

What was the Munich Putsch (1923)?

What was the result of the Munich Putsch for Hitler?

What was the Kellogg-Briand Pact?

When did Germany join the League of Nations?

What new currency ended hyperinflation?

What was the Dawes Plan?

Who led the Spartacist Uprising?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?

The Reichstag Fire | The Enabling Act (1933) | Gleichschaltung | Trade Unions | The Night of the Long Knives (1934) | Führer

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Which event was more crucial in creating the dictatorship: the Reichstag Fire or the Enabling Act?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative:

- 1. In January 1933, Hitler became Chancellor BUT...**
- 2. The Enabling Act was passed in March 1933 BECAUSE...**
- 3. The Night of the Long Knives occurred in June 1934 SO...**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Use the following five keywords in a short paragraph (3-5 sentences) that accurately describes a key step in Hitler's consolidation of power, demonstrating your understanding of their meaning and historical context: *Reichstag Fire, Emergency Decree, Enabling Act, Gleichschaltung, One-party state*.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the causal chain linking the growing power of the SA under Ernst Röhm, the concerns of the German Army, and the event known as the Night of the Long Knives. Your answer should clearly articulate how each factor contributed to the next.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine that President Paul von Hindenburg had lived for another five years beyond August 1934. How might this have altered the pace and nature of Hitler's consolidation of power and the establishment of a totalitarian dictatorship? Consider at least two specific ways Hindenburg's continued presence could have impacted events.

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: Extract from the 'Decree for the Protection of the People and the State' (Reichstag Fire Decree), 28 February 1933.

"Restrictions on personal liberty, on the right of free expression of opinion, including freedom of the press, on the right of assembly and the right of association, and violations of the privacy of postal, telegraphic, and telephonic communications... are permissible."

Q6. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about how the Nazi government used the Reichstag Fire.

(i) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:

Details in the source that tell me this:

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q1 INFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

General Notes

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L2: Key Topic 3.2: The Police State and Religion, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the different, overlapping branches of the Nazi police state, distinguishing between the roles of the SS, SD, and Gestapo.
- ☐ Analyse how the Nazis completely removed the independence of the German legal system to ensure the courts always ruled in Hitler's favour.
- ☐ Evaluate the varying successes and failures of Nazi policies towards the Catholic and Protestant churches.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the Wall Street Crash (1929)?

How did the Wall Street Crash affect Germany?

How many Germans were unemployed by 1932?

How did the Weimar government react to the Depression?

Why did Nazi support surge during the Depression?

What was the 25-Point Programme?

Who were the SA?

What book did Hitler write in prison?

What was the Munich Putsch?

Why did the 'Golden Age' end?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

SS (Schutzstaffel) | SD (Sicherheitsdienst) | Gestapo | Schutzhaft (Protective Custody) | The Concordat (1933) | Reich Church | Confessional Church

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why was the Gestapo so terrifying despite being relatively small?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete these sentences based on the lesson narrative: 1) Hitler signed the Concordat with the Catholic Church in 1933 BUT... 2) Hitler attempted to create a unified 'Reich Church' BECAUSE... 3) The Gestapo arrested many priests and pastors SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) explaining how the Nazi regime attempted to control and suppress religious institutions between 1933 and 1939. You must accurately use ALL of the following keywords: SS, SD, Gestapo, Schutzhaft, The Concordat (1933), Reich Church, Confessional Church.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the chain of events that led to the formation of the Confessional Church and the subsequent Nazi response. Your explanation should clearly link each cause to its effect.

Counter-Factual History

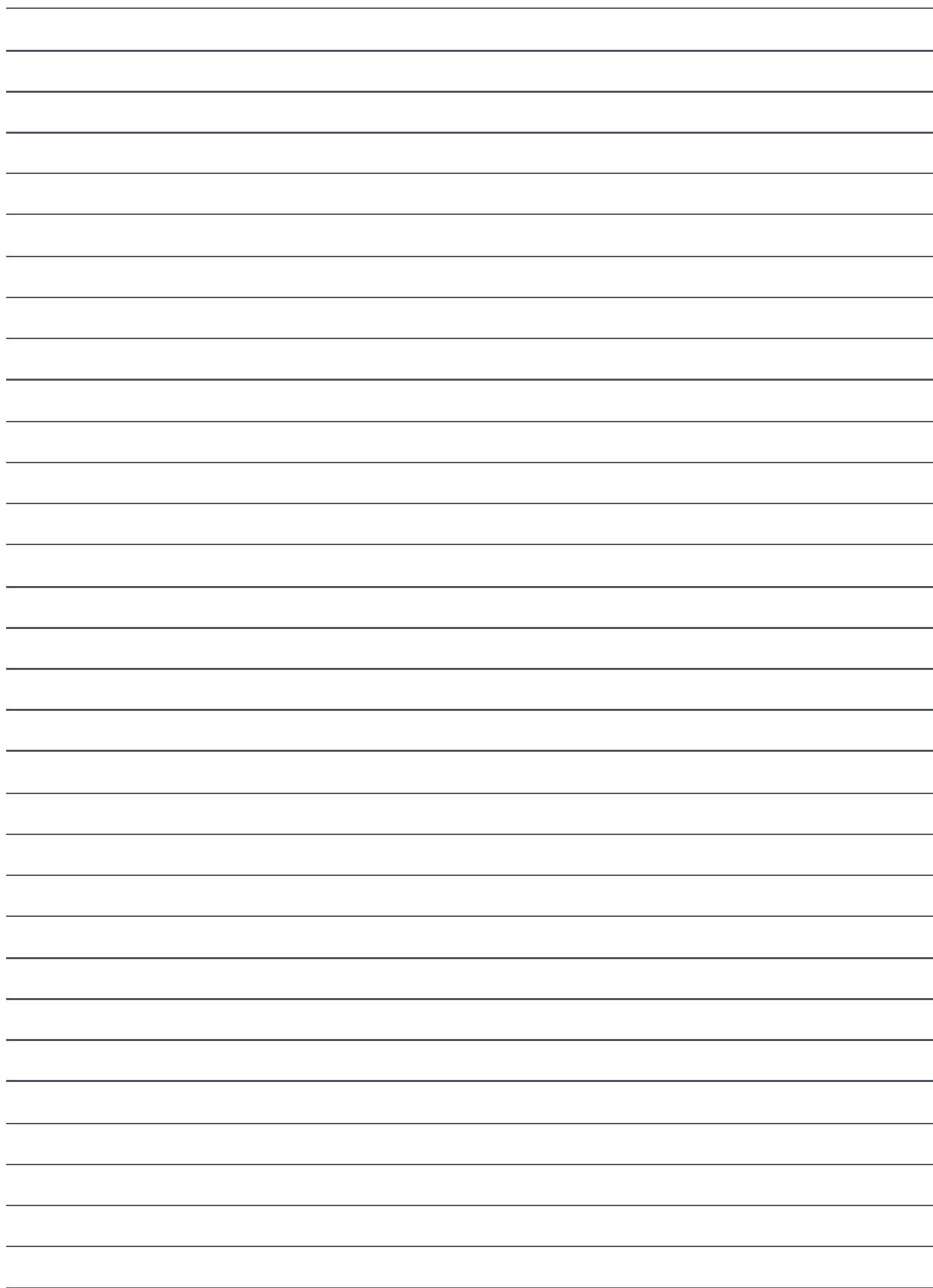
Q5. Imagine the Nazi regime, from 1933, had chosen a policy of *immediate and complete suppression* of all religious institutions (Catholic and Protestant), rather than the historical path of initial conciliation (Concordat) and gradual subversion. Analyze the potential short-term and long-term consequences of this alternative policy for the Nazi regime's power, international standing, and public support within Germany, compared to the actual historical path.

You may use the following in your answer:

- You must also use information of your own.**

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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L3: Key Topic 3.3: Controlling and Influencing Attitudes, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the methods Goebbels used to censor the press, literature, and radio.
- ☐ Analyse how the Nazis utilised mass rallies, the 1936 Berlin Olympics, and cheap technology (like the Volksempfänger) as tools of indoctrination.
- ☐ Evaluate the ways in which the Nazis crushed independent thought by controlling art, architecture, and music through the Reich Chamber of Culture.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who was Paul von Hindenburg?

Who were the three chancellors before Hitler (1930-1932)?

Why did Hindenburg appoint Hitler as Chancellor in January 1933?

What percentage of the vote did the Nazis get in July 1932?

What was the Wall Street Crash?

How many Germans were unemployed by 1932?

How did Brüning try to fix the Depression?

Who was the first President of the Weimar Republic?

What was Article 48?

What was the Dawes Plan?

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

Censorship | Propaganda | Ministry of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda | Volksempfänger (People's Receiver) | Reich Chamber of Culture | Entartete Kunst (Degenerate Art)

Power, Governance & Warfare

Economy, Trade & Society

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was Goebbels' propaganda or Himmler's terror more effective in controlling Germany?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete these sentences based on the lesson's narrative:

- 1) The Nazi regime established the Ministry of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda in March 1933, **BUT**...
- 2) Joseph Goebbels was appointed head of this Ministry **BECAUSE**...
- 3) The Nazis immediately began to control all forms of media, **SO**...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using at least three of the keywords (Censorship, Propaganda, Ministry of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda, Volksempfänger, Reich Chamber of Culture, Entartete

Kunst), write a short paragraph explaining how the Nazis controlled and influenced attitudes in Germany.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain how the Nazi regime's control over culture and media, through institutions like the Ministry of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda and the Reich Chamber of Culture, contributed to the consolidation of their power and the stability of the regime by 1939.

Q5. The 'What If' Challenge (Counter-Factual History): What if the Nazi regime had *failed* to establish effective control over radio and film in the early years (1933-1935)? How might this have significantly altered the trajectory of Nazi Germany's consolidation of power and public support by 1939?

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):

From Goebbels' written instructions to Nazi party speakers, July 1935.

"The finest kind of propaganda does not reveal itself; it works invisibly, penetrating every cell of life so that the public has no idea of its goals. For Wednesday's broadcast of the Leader's speech, all factory owners, offices, and shops must install speakers. The entire workforce must be gathered to listen, and the press must discuss this decision as the only possible path for Germany."

Source C (Contemporary Written Source):

From a private letter written by an ordinary citizen
in Hamburg, 1937.

"Every evening on the radio, we are subjected to the same repetitive speeches, military marches, and achievements of the state. The newspapers contain only approved Nazi articles, and we are expected to attend massive local rallies. While everyone stands and salutes to avoid trouble, behind closed doors, my family simply turns off the wireless, tired of the endless, mind-numbing propaganda."

Q6. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into controlling and influencing attitudes?

[8 marks • 10 mins]

[illegible]

[illegible]

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

L4: Key Topic 3.4: Opposition, Resistance and Conformity, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the different youth opposition groups, distinguishing between the working-class Edelweiss Pirates and the middle-class Swing Youth.
- ☐ Analyse the methods used by underground political networks, industrial workers, and lone-wolf attackers to resist the Nazi state.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons why the vast majority of the German population conformed to Nazi rule rather than actively opposing it.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What happened to the Reichstag building in February 1933?

What was the Decree for the Protection of the People and State?

What was the Enabling Act (March 1933)?

What did Hitler do to trade unions in May 1933?

What was the Night of the Long Knives (June 1934)?

What title did Hitler take upon Hindenburg's death in 1934?

Who appointed Hitler as Chancellor?

Who convinced Hindenburg to appoint Hitler?

What was the SA?

What was the 25-Point Programme?

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

Conformity | Passive Resistance | Active Resistance | Sopade Reports | Edelweiss Pirates | Swing Youth

"Between 1933 and 1939, youth groups like the Edelweiss Pirates and Swing Youth showed absolute Conformity to the Nazi police state by enthusiastically marching alongside the Gestapo."

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why was there so little resistance to the Nazi regime?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative:

- 1) Early opposition groups like the SPD and KPD were quickly suppressed BUT...**
- 2) The Confessional Church and Catholic Church resisted the Nazis BECAUSE...**
- 3) Most Germans conformed to Nazi rule SO...**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (approximately 100 words) explaining the different forms of opposition to the Nazi regime between 1933-1939, using at least five of the following keywords correctly: Conformity, Passive Resistance, Active Resistance, Sopade Reports, Sabotage, Edelweiss Pirates, Swing Youth.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain how a combination of Nazi policies and the nature of opposition led to widespread conformity rather than successful resistance in Germany between 1933 and 1939.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine a scenario where the SPD and KPD had managed to form a unified, underground resistance movement immediately after 1933, receiving significant support from the Confessional Church and trade unions. How might this have altered the nature and effectiveness of opposition to the Nazi regime by 1939, and what challenges would such a movement still have faced?

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Interpretation 1 (The Brave Resistance View):

The Christian Churches in Germany were largely successful in resisting the Nazi regime's attempts to achieve total control over religious life. Despite intense pressure, both the Catholic and Protestant Churches prevented the total Nazification of their institutions. The creation of the Confessing Church by thousands of brave pastors successfully defended theological independence, proving that religious faith remained a powerful barrier to totalitarian control.

Interpretation 2 (The Limited Conformity View):

Christian opposition to the Nazi regime was extremely limited, narrow, and ultimately failed to challenge the wider atrocities of the state. The vast majority of church leaders conformed because they shared Hitler's hatred of communism and feared the destruction of their institutions. When pastors spoke out, their protests were strictly limited to defending church administration; they remained entirely silent during the persecution of minorities and the destruction of democracy.

Q6. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about religious opposition to the Nazi regime. What is the main difference between these views?

EDEXCEL JUNE 2024 (Q3B INTERPRETATION DIFFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q7. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about religious opposition to the Nazi regime. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2024 (Q3C INTERPRETATION WHY)

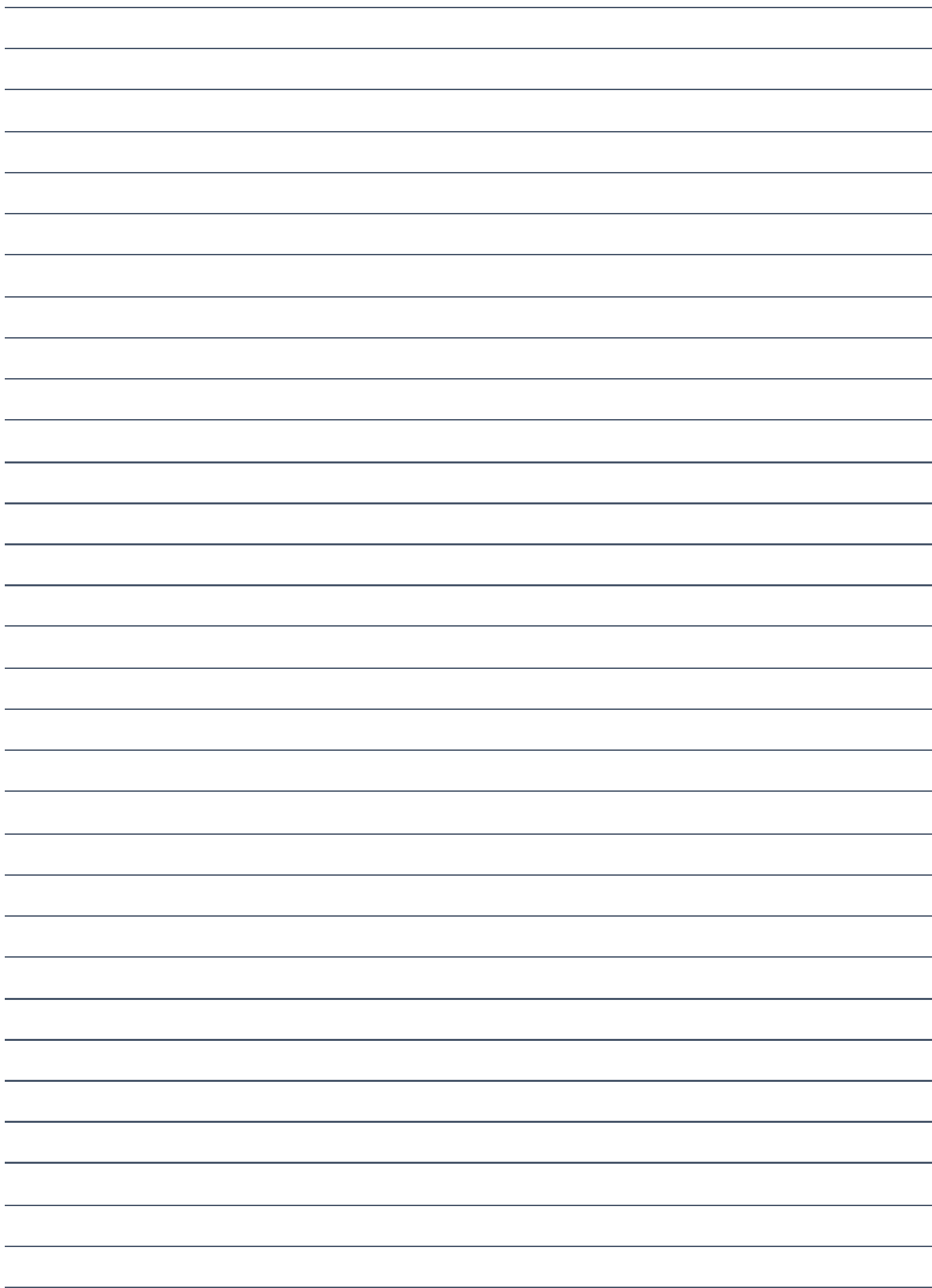
[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q8. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about religious opposition to the Nazi regime? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2024 (Q3D INTERPRETATION EVALUATION)

[16 marks • 20 mins]

[illegible]





TEACHER FEEDBACK & D.I.R.T.

Mark: _____ / 16 (+4 SPaG) | Effort: 1 2 3 4 5

SPaG Self/Peer Checklist (4 Marks):

☐ Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. Reichstag, Ebert)

☐ Historical terminology spelled accurately

☐ Punctuation separates complex clauses

What Went Well (WWW):

Even Better If (EBI):

Student D.I.R.T. Response / Correction:

[illegible]

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 3: Weimar & Nazi Germany (1918–39)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)